I compromised by having him circumcised by his pediatrician, who happened to be named John J. Ryan. You couldn't ask for a more Gentile circumcision than that. The operation took place on September 22, 1951, when David was thirty-three days old.

Bill Boyd pulled an unexpected surprise on me on October 1, 1951. He was hiring Bernie Pitt as an assistant. Bernie had been at Columbia with me in 1948 and I remembered him well.

Bill knew Bernie was a classmate of mine since Bernie had told him so. Bill therefore asked me what I thought of him. This put me in a bind. Bernie was very bright, but I remembered his sardonic sense of humor and I was convinced he would not find Bill's bumbling peculiarities as endearing as I did. Nor did I think Bill would find Bernie's occasional bitterness pleasant.

That, however, was just my opinion, and I couldn't spoil another man's job opportunity. I just said, "Well, he's got a pronounced personality, Bill. You'll have to get used to it, the way you got used to mine."

"I'm sure there will be no problem," he said.

I could just smile doubtfully.

What didn't help my self-love was that Bill's grant enabled him to pay out a sizable sum to Bernie and that Bill lacked the discretion to keep quiet about it. He proudly announced he was going to pay Bernie

$7,000—which made my $5,500 after over two years on the job look pretty sick.

To be sure, Bernie would simply be an assistant to Bill and would carry no faculty status. In view of the fact that I was only an instructor, that wasn't enough. Once again, I put pressure on Walker for a promotion in title. I said nothing about money.

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The October 1951 Galaxy appeared, containing "C-Chute," 2 and a couple of hard-cover anthologies came out with stories of mine in them: "Death Sentence" and "The Red Queen's Race." They were the ninth and tenth hard-cover anthologies to contain stories of mine, and I was becoming used to it, even unmoved by it.